project.org

STUDENT HANDOUT

GREEN LEVEL
MORE SUPPORT

Spotting Propaganda

Grades 5–8 · Social Studies

ADMIT ONE

NAME _____ DATE _____ CLASS _____

What is propaganda? Propaganda is information used to make you think or feel a certain way about something. It uses emotions instead of facts to change your mind. Propaganda isn't always lies — but it's always trying to persuade you.

01 PART 1 — Six Propaganda Techniques

1. BANDWAGON	"Everyone is doing it, so you should too!"
2. FEAR	"Something bad will happen if you don't do this!"
3. NAME-CALLING	Using mean words or images to make someone look bad
4. GLITTERING GENERALITIES	Big positive words like "freedom" or "honor" without real meaning
5. TRANSFER	Connecting a cause to something you already love (flag, family, religion)
6. TESTIMONIAL	A famous or trusted person says you should do something

02 PART 2 — Analyze This Image

Look at the propaganda image your teacher shows. Answer these questions:

What do you see? (Describe the image) _____

_____

_____

_____

How does it make you feel? (Circle all that apply)

Proud Scared Angry Guilty Excited Sad

Which technique does it use? (Pick from the list in Part 1) _____

What does the creator want you to DO?

PART 3

03 Match the Technique!

Draw a line from each example to the propaganda technique it uses:

"Join the army — everyone else is!"	FEAR
"The enemy wants to destroy your family!"	BANDWAGON
"Famous actor says: Buy war bonds!"	GLITTERING GENERALITIES
"Fight for freedom and honor!"	TESTIMONIAL

MINI MUSEUM CONNECTION

In the 1860s, "spirit photographers" used fake ghost images to sell false hope to grieving families. This was propaganda too — manipulating emotions (grief) to get something (money). The techniques haven't changed!

minimuseumproject.org/exhibitions/seeing-is-deceiving

SHARE WITH YOUR FAMILY

Watch a TV commercial with your family. Can you spot any propaganda techniques? Most ads use at least one!